

Yousician Strategic Environment Mapping

A brief-led ecosystem report: who influences music learning, who appears successful, who shapes music as a hobby, and which actors define Yousician's strategic environment.

96

tracked ecosystem records

Broad database across brief categories.

28

key-player profiles

All marked key players are included without one-page blank spillover.

48

board-timeline news moves

Grade A/B recent moves; static context kept out of main timeline.

credentialed Appfigures rows

Performance ranking is not finalized because credentialed Appfigures data is pending. Revenue, downloads, rank trends, review velocity and country mix must not be treated as complete.

28

relationship rows pending

Completion layer is prepared for Yousician owners.

157

hard claim rows

Funding, ownership, reach, AI and M&A claims require source-level review.

Executive Summary

The environment around Yousician is not only a direct-competitor market. It is shaped by learning apps, hardware brands, song and practice platforms, teachers and education bodies, creator educators, hobby software, AI tools, rights owners, investors, media and cultural demand drivers.

The current package is discussion-ready as a market report. It is not yet Board-final for app-performance conclusions because Appfigures is not populated, and it is not relationship-final because internal Yousician owner/status fields remain open.

What the brief asks, answered first

Who influences the future of music learning?

Direct learning apps, hardware-backed ecosystems, song/practice systems, AI feedback utilities, creator educators, teachers, schools and formal education benchmarks.

Who is successful?

Success should be read across habit, repertoire ownership, creator trust, distribution, AI utility, funding momentum and app-store performance. App-store performance is blocked until credentialed Appfigures data is imported.

Who influences music as a hobby?

TikTok, YouTube, Spotify, artists, song libraries, creator tools, AI generation tools, instrument brands, retailers and cultural moments influence what people want to play, make and share.

Who shapes Yousician's strategic environment?

AI companies, rights owners, app-based competitors, hardware brands, creators, publishers, investors, awards/funding bodies and education benchmarks jointly shape the field.

The 10 actors or clusters that should lead the executive read

Rank	Actor Or Cluster	Primary Influence Layer	Guiding Question Answered	Priority Reason	Board Use Status	Next Validation Step
1	Suno	AI creation and rights risk	Music as a hobby; strategic environment	Suno is the clearest signal that music participation can move from learning an instrument to prompting, generating and sharing music, while also triggering rights and licensing risk.	Usable as a strategic signal; do not use as an adoption or revenue ranking without validated metrics.	Confirm latest funding, litigation status and rights-owner positioning before board use.
2	Music.AI / Moises	AI practice utility and creator tooling	Music learning; music as a hobby	Moises connects AI directly to practice utility: stems, isolation, transcription and creator workflow reduce friction between song discovery and playing.	Usable as a capability and ecosystem signal; not performance-ranked yet.	Import Appfigures and verify user/reach claims from official or investor-grade sources.
3	Simply / JoyTunes	Direct app-based learning benchmark	Music learning; who is successful	Simply is the closest mobile learning benchmark for onboarding, motivation, subscription learning and beginner conversion.	Do not rank as successful by performance until credentialed Appfigures data is imported.	Run credentialed Appfigures export for Simply Piano and Simply Guitar.
4	Ultimate Guitar / Muse Group	Song-practice habit and repertoire ownership	Music learning; music as a hobby	Ultimate Guitar controls a major song-to-practice surface: tabs, chords, community and repeated practice intent.	Usable as a category-influence signal; not yet a quantified scale comparison.	Validate traffic, app performance and Muse Group ownership/source claims.
5	BandLab	Creation community and hobby expansion	Music as a hobby; strategic environment	BandLab represents the path where hobbyists create, collaborate and publish rather than only learn or practice.	Usable as ecosystem position; avoid quantified reach claims unless sourced.	Validate platform reach, product changes and AI/creator tooling claims.
6	TikTok / YouTube music discovery	Discovery, demand creation and creator trust	Music as a hobby; music learning	These platforms shape what beginners want to play and which creators they trust before a learning product is considered.	Usable as demand-generation layer; creator reach table still needs social exports.	Complete TikTok/Instagram/YouTube creator reach exports and average-view validation.
7	Fender / Gibson / Yamaha hardware ecosystems	Instrument access, bundles and branded learning funnels	Music learning; strategic environment	Hardware brands can turn instrument purchase, setup, app onboarding and lesson subscription into one beginner journey.	Usable as ecosystem/partner layer; not as partner pipeline without Yousician input.	Confirm internal relationship owners and Appfigures for Fender Play/Gibson App where relevant.
8	Splice	Paid creator tools and rights-aware workflow	Music as a hobby; strategic environment	Splice shows that hobby participation can become paid creator workflow, sample access and production learning.	Usable as creator-tool context; avoid scale claims without source validation.	Validate current AI/sample/product positioning and creator reach metrics.
9	ABRSM / Trinity / School of Rock education layer	Trust, curriculum, certification and teacher/parent influence	Music learning; strategic environment	Education bodies and school networks shape credibility, progression, parent trust and teacher recommendations.	Usable as trust/benchmark layer; not as relationship map until internal fields are filled.	Prioritize by beginner influence, geography and feasible relationship path.
10	Spotify / labels / rights infrastructure	Rights, artist data, repertoire and AI governance	Music as a hobby; strategic environment	Rights owners and music platforms set the permission, repertoire and artist-authenticity context for AI, songs and learning content.	Usable as external environment signal; do not infer Yousician relationship or licensing status.	Confirm current rights-policy position and internal licensing relationship fields.

What the ecosystem currently looks like

1 / VERY CLOSE

Direct learning and practice apps

Simply, Flowkey, Skoove, Fender Play, Gibson App, Rocksmith+, Guitar Tricks, Pickup Music

These players compete or benchmark directly on beginner learning, practice feedback, lessons, song-led curricula and subscription habits.

2 / CLOSE

Song and repertoire ownership

Ultimate Guitar, MuseScore, Songsterr, Chordify, Chord ai, YouTube

Song demand and repertoire access shape what learners actually practice and why they return.

3 / CLOSE / PARTNERSHIP SURFACE

Hardware-backed beginner funnels

Fender, Gibson, Yamaha, Positive Grid, Donner, retailers

Instrument purchase is a major entry point; brands can bundle apps, lessons, setup and accessories into the beginner journey.

4 / CLOSE / ADJACENT UTILITY

AI practice utility

Moises, Chord ai, Chordify AI features, transcription/stem tools

These tools reduce the distance from song discovery to usable practice assets such as stems, chords and transcriptions.

5 / ADJACENT HOBBY EXPANSION

Creation and production tools

BandLab, Splice, GarageBand, Ableton, FL Studio, Soundtrap

Learners increasingly move from playing to creating, remixing, producing and sharing.

6 / ADJACENT TRUST AND ACQUISITION LAYER

Creator educators and media demand

JustinGuitar, Marty Music, Drumeo, Pianote, Rick Beato, Paul Davids, Guitar World, MusicRadar, MusicTech

Creators and media shape trust, song demand, lesson expectations and the beginner's mental model of progress.

7 / TRUST / BENCHMARK LAYER

Formal education and teacher networks

ABRSM, Trinity, RSL Awards, MTNA, Berklee Online, School of Rock, teacher platforms

These bodies influence standards, credibility, parent trust, teacher recommendations and progression pathways.

8 / STRATEGIC ENVIRONMENT

AI creation, rights and platform governance

Suno, Udio, ElevenLabs Music, labels, RIAA, Spotify, YouTube, TikTok

AI generation and rights governance reshape what music participation, repertoire use and content authenticity mean.

9 / OPPORTUNITY AND SIGNAL LAYER

Capital, awards and public funding

VC/growth funds, strategic investors, Business Finland, Horizon Europe, awards ecosystems

Funding and awards indicate where the market sees momentum and where non-dilutive or credibility opportunities may exist.

Brief-category coverage

Music hobby software ecosystem

26 database records / 8 key players

Investors, media, awards, funding and cultural drivers

22 database records / 2 key players

Music learning apps and platforms

15 database records / 9 key players

Teachers, schools and music education organizations / wider education

13 database records / 1 key players

Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors

11 database records / 4 key players

AI companies and AI initiatives

9 database records / 4 key players

Last 24 months: curated market moves

The main table uses Grade A/B items only. Appendix-only rows are retained as context but should not carry the board narrative.

Date	Move Type	Player Or Signal	What Happened	Why It Matters For Yousician	Confidence	News Grade
2024-06-24	AI rights / litigation	Suno / Udio / RIAA	Major record companies filed copyright infringement cases against Suno and Udio.	AI music moved from novelty to rights, licensing and board-level risk.	High	A
2024-08-01	Policy / AI governance	European Union AI Act	The EU AI Act entered into force, with transparency rules for AI-generated content and GPAI obligations phasing in.	EU AI transparency and copyright compliance expectations matter for AI-enabled music learning and creation tools.	High	A
2024-09-24	Platform move	TikTok Music	TikTok announced it would shut down TikTok Music and focus on music discovery in the main TikTok app.	Music discovery power remains in social platforms even when full streaming products retreat.	Medium	B
2024-09-25	Hardware + software bundle	Duolingo / Loog	Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.	Consumer learning platforms are testing physical beginner bundles.	Medium	B
2024-11-12	AI product experiment	YouTube Dream Track	YouTube tested AI restyling of licensed songs for Shorts using Dream Track technology.	Short-form video platforms are turning licensed music into editable creator material.	Medium	B
2024-11-15	Marketplace closure	Microsoft TakeLessons	Microsoft's TakeLessons marketplace closed, with account access ending in November 2024.	Online lesson marketplaces remain fragile; teacher acquisition and continuity are strategic surfaces.	High	A
2025-01-22	Funding / AI utility	Music.AI / Moises	Music.AI raised a \$40M Series A and reported Moises at 50M users.	AI practice utilities have meaningful reach and investor momentum.	High	A
2025-01-29	Policy / copyright	U.S. Copyright Office	The U.S. Copyright Office published Part 2 of its AI report on copyrightability of AI outputs.	Human-authorship rules affect generated content, practice tools and creator workflows.	High	A
2025-03-17	Education network signal	School of Rock	School of Rock social channels referenced roughly 400 global locations.	Offline music schools remain scaled trust and accountability channels.	Medium	B
2025-04-28	M&A / creator tools	Splice / Spitfire Audio	Splice announced the acquisition of Spitfire Audio.	Creator-tool platforms are consolidating premium sound libraries for AI-assisted creation.	High	A
2025-06-03	Artist insights	TikTok for Artists	TikTok for Artists launched globally after beta testing, initially in 26 countries.	TikTok is becoming structured music analytics and promotion infrastructure.	High	A
2025-08-01	AI music generation	ElevenLabs Music	ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music generation.	Major voice/audio AI providers moved into full music creation.	High	A
2025-08-20	AI practice / creation	Moises AI Studio	Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation support.	Practice utilities are expanding toward creation co-pilots.	High	A
2025-09-25	AI governance	Spotify	Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and songwriters.	Streaming-platform AI rules shape discovery, identity and rights expectations.	High	A
2025-09-30	Funding call	Creative Europe MEDIA	The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call opened.	Interactive learning, gamified practice or immersive music products may fit future EU creative funding routes.	High	A
2025-10-02	Product launch	Splice INSTRUMENT	Splice moved beyond samples with a cloud-connected instrument plugin drawing on Spitfire libraries.	Creator platforms are reducing friction from inspiration to playable sound.	Medium	B
2025-10-29	AI rights / licensing	UMG / Udio	UMG and Udio settled litigation and announced agreements for a licensed AI music creation platform planned for 2026.	A licensed AI music lane is emerging alongside litigation.	High	A
2025-11-19	Funding / AI music	Suno	Suno raised a \$250M Series C at a \$2.45B post-money valuation.	AI music generation has crossed into large-scale venture-backed consumer infrastructure.	High	A
2025-11-25	AI rights / partnership	Warner Music Group / Suno	Warner Music Group and Suno announced a partnership and settlement path for licensed AI models.	Major labels are beginning to define opt-in licensed AI models, not only legal opposition.	High	A

Date	Move Type	Player Or Signal	What Happened	Why It Matters For Yousician	Confidence	News Grade
2025-12-03	Artist data	Spotify Wrapped for Artists	Spotify provided personalized Wrapped experiences for artists, songwriters, creators and advertisers.	Music platforms are expanding shareable analytics loops around identity and fandom.	High	A
2025-12-10	Cultural signal	TikTok Year in Music	TikTok named global 2025 music signals and highlighted Add to Music App behavior.	Short-form music demand increasingly predicts what users may want to sing, play or learn.	High	A
2025-12-14	Award / EdTech	WorldWiDE EdTech Awards	The 2026 WorldWiDE EdTech Awards nomination deadline closed.	Education awards provide low-cost credibility routes if evidence of learning impact is documented.	Medium	B
2026-01-07	Funding deadline	EIC Accelerator	The first 2026 EIC Accelerator full-application cut-off occurred.	Public deep-tech funding remains relevant for high-risk AI practice or learning innovations.	Medium	B
2026-02-06	Award deadline	Webby Awards	The 30th Annual Webby Awards extended entry deadline closed.	Apps, software, immersive and creator categories are relevant for brand and product recognition.	High	A
2026-02-11	Funding deadline	Creative Europe MEDIA	The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call deadline closed.	Music-learning/game-like products need early planning for EU creative funding cycles.	Medium	B
2026-03-01	Awards / education	EdTech Awards	The EdTech Awards 2026 announced finalists and winners in March 2026.	Learning-product credibility can be strengthened through education technology awards.	High	A
2026-03-15	Rights / royalties	Spotify Loud & Clear	Spotify's 2026 transparency reporting said 2025 payouts to the music industry exceeded \$11B.	Rights-holder economics affect catalog, artist relations and music-learning licensing context.	Medium	B
2026-04-15	AI creator tools	Splice	Splice announced generative AI tools tied to its creator compensation model.	Human-made licensed sample catalogs are being combined with traceable generative workflows.	Medium	B
2026-04-20	Award opening	Brandon Hall EdTech Awards	The Excellence in EdTech Awards launched for 2026 entries with a September deadline.	Operationally relevant award for learning products with measurable outcomes.	High	A
2026-04-30	Platform growth	YouTube Music / Premium	Alphabet reported record quarterly growth for YouTube Music and Premium non-trial subscribers.	YouTube remains central to hobby music discovery, lessons, creators and paid music consumption.	Medium	B
2026-05-01	Developer ecosystem	Google Play	Google Play summarized Q1 2026 discovery and developer tools updates.	App-store discovery and merchandising remain important for music-learning acquisition.	High	A
2026-05-18	Awards / iOS	Apple Design Awards	Apple announced 2026 Apple Design Award finalists.	Apple design recognition remains a benchmark for app craft, accessibility and interaction.	High	A
2026-06-01	App accelerator	Google Play Apps Accelerator	Google Play announced the first Apps Accelerator class of 2026.	Platform accelerator programs are a route for app growth, merchandising and developer relationships.	High	A
2026-06-05	AI rights / labor	AFM / UMG / WMG	The American Federation of Musicians sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing to Suno and Udio.	AI-rights exposure now includes session musician compensation and labor claims.	Medium	B
2026-06-08	AI creation tooling	BandLab SongStarter	BandLab's help center updated SongStarter guidance for AI-generated song ideas.	Large creator communities are normalizing AI as a lightweight idea-generation layer.	High	A
2026-06-10	AI rights / platform data	Google / YouTube / Lyria	Independent musicians sued Google over alleged use of YouTube-uploaded music for Lyria AI training.	Creator-platform data rights are becoming material to AI music tooling and trust.	Medium	B
2026-06-10	Hardware + AI software	Fender Studio Pro / Moises	Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant.	Instrument brands are moving deeper into app, DAW and AI utility territory.	Medium	B
2026-06-10	Award / iOS	Apple Design Awards	Apple revealed 2026 Design Award winners across app and game categories.	Awards can reveal current interaction and visual-quality benchmarks for consumer apps.	High	A
2024-10-01	Education / apps	ABRSM	ABRSM's 2024 impact report quantified global exams, qualifications and teacher support.	Formal assessment bodies still shape parent, teacher and serious-learner trust.	High	A
2025-01-15	Publishing / rights	Muse Group / Hal Leonard	Muse Group unified Hal Leonard US and Europe into a global publishing operation.	Song rights, notation, tabs and learning content are becoming more ecosystem-controlled.	Medium	B
2025-04-10	Artist platform	TikTok for Artists beta	Coverage indicated TikTok was preparing a dedicated artist insights platform before global launch.	TikTok is formalizing the data layer around music discovery.	Medium	B
2025-05-01	Education platform	Berklee Online	Berklee Online positioned itself as the world's largest online music school with 30,000+ learners from 140+ countries.	High-trust online music education offers a benchmark for credentialed, instructor-led learning.	High	A
2025-10-22	Youth performance	School of Rock / Warped Tour	School of Rock locations announced student performers at Warped Tour Orlando.	Performance-based learning connects lessons with youth culture and live music moments.	Medium	B

Date	Move Type	Player Or Signal	What Happened	Why It Matters For Yousician	Confidence	News Grade
2026-01-22	Investor thesis	Menlo Ventures / Suno	Menlo framed Suno as participatory music creation in its Series C thesis.	Venture theses are shifting from music consumption to participatory creation.	High	A
2026-02-17	Funding result	EIC Accelerator	61 startups and SMEs secured EIC Accelerator support in the latest round.	EU deep-tech funding remains competitive but meaningful for high-risk innovation.	High	A
2026-04-02	AI awards	Tom's Guide AI Awards	Tom's Guide AI Awards nominations closed for 2026.	Consumer AI awards are useful external signals for AI utility positioning.	Medium	B
2026-05-22	Creator / hardware culture	Rick Beato / Gibson / Nuno Bettencourt	Guitar media highlighted Rick Beato's live collaboration at Six-String Sanctuary and use of signature Gibson gear.	Creator educators increasingly bridge learning, artist culture and hardware marketing.	Medium	B
2026-06-03	Funding / public RDI	Business Finland	Business Finland funding listings showed open R&D and internationalization funding routes.	As a Finnish company, Yousician can screen public RDI funding against product and AI initiatives.	High	A

- AI companies and AI initiatives: 13
- Media, publishers and cultural drivers: 9
- Awards: 7
- Funding: 6
- Teachers, schools and music education organizations: 5
- Music hobby software ecosystem: 3
- Wider education and self-improvement ecosystem: 1
- Music learning apps and platforms: 1
- Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors: 1
- Investors active in the space: 1
- Influencers, creators and educators: 1

Appfigures is a mandatory gate, not an optional nice-to-have

Performance ranking is not finalized because credentialed Appfigures data is pending. Revenue, downloads, rank trends, review velocity and country mix must not be treated as complete.
16 app rows are ready for credentialed export/import; 0 credentialed rows are currently populated. Public app-store ratings or reviews are proxies only and must not be described as Appfigures.

The full 16-row Appfigures request pack is included as a completion file. The report shows a compact sample so the main PDF does not become an operational table dump.

Player	App Name	App Store Id Or Package	Credentialed Status	Next Action
Simply	Simply Guitar - Learn Guitar	1476695335 / com.joytunes.simplyguitar	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Simply	Simply Piano	1019442026 / com.joytunes.simplypiano	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Flowkey	flowkey - Learn to Play Piano	1020357408 / com.flowkey.app	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Skoove	Skoove: Learn Piano	1160668178 / com.skoove.piano	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Fender Play	Fender Play: Learn Guitar	1226057939 / com.fender.play	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Gibson App	Gibson: Learn & Play Guitar	To validate	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Moises	Moises: The Musician's App	1515796612 / ai.moises	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Ultimate Guitar	Ultimate Guitar: Chords & Tabs	357828853 / com.ultimateguitar.tabs	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
MuseScore	MuseScore - Sheet Music & Chords	835731296 / com.musescore.playerlite	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.
Songsterr	Songsterr Tabs & Chords	399211291 / com.songsterr	Missing from package	Export Appfigures app performance rows and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.

Teachers, creators, investors, media, awards and funding

Teachers / schools

17

Education bodies and teacher networks shape trust, progression, certification language and parent confidence.

Creators

26

Creator educators influence discovery, trust and beginner motivation. Platform reach remains partly pending.

Investors

22

Capital flows around music, education, creator tools and AI indicate adjacent market momentum.

Media / culture

28

Media, platforms and cultural drivers explain demand formation before app consideration.

Awards

12

Award entries are now usable as an operational tracker with fit, timing and effort fields.

Funding

12

Funding opportunities are separated from investors and marked by geography, eligibility and effort.

KEY PLAYERS

All 28 key players, without placeholder-looking one-pagers

Profiles are intentionally compact. Missing news, performance or relationship data is treated as a validation status rather than forced into empty boxes.

KP-01 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Simply

Role: Direct learning app

Why it matters: Useful benchmark for onboarding, motivation, pricing, and growth in app-based music education.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-02 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

Ultimate Guitar

Role: Song-practice ecosystem

Why it matters: Strong influence on how hobbyists discover songs and move from inspiration to practice.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-03 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Fender Play

Role: Brand-backed learning app

Why it matters: Shows how instrument makers can extend into software, subscriptions, and beginner journeys.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-04 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Flowkey

Role: Instrument learning app

Why it matters: Important benchmark for piano learning, catalog positioning, and conversion mechanics.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-05 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

JustinGuitar

Role: Creator-led practice ecosystem

Why it matters: Shows the power of trusted teachers and free content in shaping learner behavior.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-06 / INSTRUMENT BRANDS, MANUFACTURERS AND DISTRIBUTORS

Low

Fender

Role: Hardware ecosystem

Why it matters: Instrument brands can shape the beginner funnel before users choose a learning app.

Recent move: 2026-06-10: Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-07 / INSTRUMENT BRANDS, MANUFACTURERS AND DISTRIBUTORS

Low

Yamaha

Role: Hardware and education ecosystem

Why it matters: Influences hardware access, music education channels, and partner possibilities.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-08 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

BandLab

Role: Creation and social platform

Why it matters: Represents the shift from learning an instrument to making and sharing music quickly.

Recent move: 2026-06-08: BandLab's help center updated SongStarter guidance for AI-generated song ideas. | 2025-02-01: BandLab continued to present itself as a 10...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-09 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

Splice

Role: Creator marketplace

Why it matters: Shows how hobbyists and creators pay for tools that accelerate making music.

Recent move: 2026-04-15: Splice announced generative AI tools tied to its creator compensation model. | 2025-10-02: Splice moved beyond samples with a cloud-conne...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-10 / AI COMPANIES AND AI INITIATIVES

Low

Suno

Role: AI creation disruptor

Why it matters: May shift the meaning of music participation, motivation, and creation for casual users.

Recent move: 2026-01-22: Menlo framed Suno as participatory music creation in its Series C thesis. | 2025-11-25: Warner Music Group and Suno announced a partnersh...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-11 / AI COMPANIES AND AI INITIATIVES

Low

Udio

Role: AI creation disruptor

Why it matters: Important to understand whether AI creation competes with, complements, or expands music learning.

Recent move: 2026-06-10: Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant. | 2025-10-29: UMG and Udio settle...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-12 / AI COMPANIES AND AI INITIATIVES

Medium

Moises

Role: AI practice utility

Why it matters: Strong example of AI improving practice workflows without replacing instrument learning.

Recent move: 2026-06-10: Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant. | 2025-08-20: Moises launched AI...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-13 / TEACHERS, SCHOOLS AND MUSIC EDUCATION ORGANIZATIONS / WIDER EDUCATION

Low

Duolingo

Role: Consumer learning benchmark

Why it matters: Not music-specific, but highly relevant for learning loops, retention, brand, and AI in education.

Recent move: 2024-09-25: Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-14 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Guitar Tricks

Role: Structured guitar learning platform

Why it matters: Important guitar-specific subscription benchmark for curriculum depth, song-led learning, and adult beginner messaging.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-15 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Medium

Pickup Music

Role: Structured guitar learning platform

Why it matters: Useful benchmark for higher-intent guitarists, modern aesthetics, community, and guided weekly practice.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-16 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Low

Rocksmith+

Role: Interactive song-learning service

Why it matters: Important benchmark for real-time feedback, licensed songs, game-like practice, and multi-instrument expansion.

Recent move: 2024-06-20: Rocksmith+ continued cross-platform subscription positioning for learning real songs with real instruments.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-17 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Gibson App

Role: Brand-backed guitar learning app

Why it matters: Shows how a major guitar brand can bundle learning with instrument purchase and beginner motivation.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-18 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

Chordify

Role: Song-chord practice utility

Why it matters: Owns a high-intent moment between song discovery and self-guided practice.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-19 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

YouTube

Role: Music discovery and creator platform

Why it matters: A major substitute and funnel for self-guided learning; it shapes inspiration, discovery, and expectations of free content.

Recent move: 2026-06-10: Independent musicians sued Google over alleged use of YouTube-uploaded music for Lyria AI training. | 2026-04-30: Alphabet reported recor...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-20 / INSTRUMENT BRANDS, MANUFACTURERS AND DISTRIBUTORS

Low

Gibson

Role: Hardware and brand ecosystem

Why it matters: Hardware brands can capture learner intent before software choice and can bundle education into purchase moments.

Recent move: 2026-05-22: Guitar media highlighted Rick Beato's live collaboration at Six-String Sanctuary and use of signature Gibson gear.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-21 / INSTRUMENT BRANDS, MANUFACTURERS AND DISTRIBUTORS

Low

Positive Grid

Role: Smart amp and practice ecosystem

Why it matters: Shows how hardware can become an app-led practice surface and compete for daily guitar time.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-22 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Low

FL Studio

Role: Accessible production platform

Why it matters: Shapes the path from musical interest to beat-making, production, and creator identity.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-23 / AI COMPANIES AND AI INITIATIVES

Low

ElevenLabs Music

Role: AI music and audio platform

Why it matters: Important because major AI audio platforms may enter music creation, rights, and creator tooling at scale.

Recent move: 2025-08-01: ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music generation.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-24 / INVESTORS, MEDIA, AWARDS, FUNDING AND CULTURAL DRIVERS

Low

Spotify for Artists

Role: Artist analytics and promotion platform

Why it matters: Important for how hobbyists understand music success, release goals, artist identity, and AI-authenticity debates.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-25 / INVESTORS, MEDIA, AWARDS, FUNDING AND CULTURAL DRIVERS

Low

TikTok for Artists

Role: Music discovery and artist insights platform

Why it matters: TikTok can shape song discovery, cultural momentum, and what learners want to play.

Recent move: 2025-06-03: TikTok for Artists launched globally after beta testing, initially in 26 countries. | 2025-04-10: Coverage indicated TikTok was preparing...

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-26 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Low

Musora

Role: Multi-instrument lesson ecosystem

Why it matters: Adds an important multi-instrument subscription benchmark beyond single-instrument apps.

Recent move: 2025-09-01: Musora education brands continued to scale YouTube-led funnels for piano, drums, guitar and voice.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-27 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

Fretello

Role: Guitar learning app

Why it matters: Directly relevant for guitar onboarding, lesson pacing, personalization, and app-store positioning.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

KP-28 / MUSIC HOBBY SOFTWARE ECOSYSTEM

Pending

Chord ai

Role: AI chord recognition app

Why it matters: Important because it moves AI directly into the song-to-practice moment that GuitarTuna/Yousician users care about.

Recent move: 2024-07-15: Chord ai public listings positioned AI chord, beat and song-structure recognition as a play-any-song utility.

Validation: Validate Appfigures/traffic or investor data where applicable; confirm internal relationship owner.

Performance: Appfigures gate: credentialed performance data pending.

Relationship: Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

What is not optional before Board / investor use

Appendix

Appfigures

Blocked until credentialed export/API data is imported. No app-performance ranking should be finalized.

Hard claims

157 hard claim rows require source-level confidence review before high-stakes use.

Relationships

Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

Source review

12 source-change review items and 78 refresh retry/access rows remain open.

Check Id	Label	Status	Count	Detail	Next Action
key_players	All 28 key players present	passed	28	28 key-player rows are present.	Keep at 28 unless the key-player scope changes.
market_moves	Board timeline depth	passed	48	48 curated market moves are marked for board timeline use.	Keep weaker context items in appendix-only status.
appfigures	Credentialed Appfigures gate	blocked	0	0 of 16 app rows are credentialed Appfigures imports.	Import Appfigures export/API output before app revenue/download/rank conclusions.
appfigures_request	Appfigures request pack	passed	16	16 request rows are ready for credentialed export.	Use the request pack as the source list for Appfigures export.
relationships	Relationship completion layer	blocked	28	28 of 28 relationship rows still need Yousician owner input.	Do not infer relationships externally; assign internal owners.
review_queue	Open source-change review queue	warning	12	12 source-change/new-source rows remain open after excluding refresh retry/access rows.	Review or reject source changes before board use.
refresh_retries	Refresh retry/access rows	warning	78	78 open rows are local refresh retry/access checks, not accepted market claims.	Retry when network/source access is available or replace inaccessible sources.
review_duplicates	Duplicate open refresh rows	warning	12	12 sources have repeated open refresh rows.	Safe fix marks older duplicate rows as superseded and keeps the latest row open.
proxy_note_duplicates	Repeated public proxy notes	passed	0	0 Appfigures proxy rows contain repeated note text.	Safe fix de-duplicates repeated note sentences without changing metrics.
hard_claims	Hard-claim source confidence	warning	33	33 hard claims still have Low/Pending source confidence.	Validate ownership, funding, user counts, AI and M&A claims before investor-facing use.
source_confidence	Source audit confidence	warning	42	42 source-audit rows are Low/Pending.	Upgrade only with stronger source review; do not auto-promote.

Claims, source confidence and remaining gaps

Appendix

Source confidence mix: {'Pending': 17, 'Low': 25, 'Medium': 82, 'High': 62}. The full source audit and claim-source matrix remain in the database and CSV appendix.

Gap	Status	Detail	Priority	Next Action	Owner Placeholder
Appfigures metrics	Blocked / credentialed export required	Revenue, downloads, ranks, ratings velocity, country mix and 12-month trends remain pending unless populated from a credentialed Appfigures export.	Critical	Export the Appfigures request pack and run scripts/import_appfigures_export.py with --credentialed.	Yousician / Appfigures credential owner
Internal relationship status	Blocked / internal owner input required	No internal relationship ownership, history or sensitivity has been assumed. Relationship fields are prepared for Yousician completion.	Critical	Assigned Yousician owners complete relationship owner, status, sensitivity and last-contact fields.	Yousician owners
Private company ownership and revenue	Partially validated / paid database or direct validation required	Public source status is captured, but ownership, investor history and revenue for private players require Crunchbase, PitchBook, Dealroom or direct validation.	High	Run a paid-database validation pass for private companies before investor/board usage.	Research owner TBD
Influencer multi-platform reach	Partially complete / platform export required	YouTube reach is included where visible. TikTok, Instagram and average views remain marked as pending platform export for campaign planning.	High	Use YouTube/TikTok/Instagram channel exports or creator tools to fill current reach and average-view fields.	Creator/partnership owner TBD
Traffic and SEO	Blocked / Similarweb or analytics-grade export required	Web traffic for song/practice ecosystems, teacher platforms and media drivers requires Similarweb or a comparable analytics export.	Medium	Run Similarweb export for priority domains and label it as public/third-party traffic estimate.	Research owner TBD
Awards and funding deadlines	Operationalized / quarterly refresh needed	Awards and funding rows now contain deadlines, effort, fit and immediate next steps; date cycles should still be refreshed quarterly.	Low	Review deadlines at the start of each quarter and assign an ops/comms owner before submission decisions.	Ops / comms owner TBD
User research linkage	Blocked / Confluence research-database access required	Market signals should be linked back to Yousician user research before turning observations into recommendations. This pass does not have Confluence research database access.	Medium	Search the Yousician User Research Database for guitar beginner motivation, FTUX, churn, pricing and competitor studies and add study links to the report appendix.	Research / strategy owner TBD

Hard claim sample

Entity	Claim Type	Claim	Source Confidence	Review Action
Simply	Ownership / investors	Simply Ltd	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Ultimate Guitar	Ownership / investors	Muse Group	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Fender Play	Ownership / investors	Fender	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Flowkey	Ownership / investors	flowkey GmbH; Yamaha is a hardware-promotion partner, not shown here as owner	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
JustinGuitar	Ownership / investors	Independent	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Fender	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Yamaha	Ownership / investors	Public company	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
BandLab	Ownership / investors	BandLab Technologies	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Splice	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Suno	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.

Entity	Claim Type	Claim	Source Confidence	Review Action
Udio	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Moises	Ownership / investors	Private	Medium	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Duolingo	Ownership / investors	Public company	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Guitar Tricks	Ownership / investors	Guitar Tricks Inc.	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Pickup Music	Ownership / investors	Pickup Music, Inc.	Medium	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Rocksmith+	Ownership / investors	Ubisoft	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Gibson App	Ownership / investors	Gibson	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Chordify	Ownership / investors	Chordify B.V.	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
YouTube	Ownership / investors	Google / Alphabet	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Gibson	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Positive Grid	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
FL Studio	Ownership / investors	Image-Line	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
ElevenLabs Music	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Spotify for Artists	Ownership / investors	Spotify	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
TikTok for Artists	Ownership / investors	ByteDance	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Musora	Ownership / investors	Private	Low	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Fretello	Ownership / investors	Fretello GmbH	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Chord ai	Ownership / investors	Nomad AI	Pending	Validate with official/company/investor database before investor-facing use.
Suno / Udio / RIAA	Market move	2024-06-24: Major record companies filed copyright infringement cases against Suno and Udio.	High	Verify source before final board snapshot.
European Union AI Act	Market move	2024-08-01: The EU AI Act entered into force, with transparency rules for AI-generated content and GPAI obligations phasing in.	High	Verify source before final board snapshot.
TikTok Music	Market move	2024-09-24: TikTok announced it would shut down TikTok Music and focus on music discovery in the main TikTok app.	Medium	Verify source before final board snapshot.
Duolingo / Loog	Market move	2024-09-25: Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.	Medium	Verify source before final board snapshot.
YouTube Dream Track	Market move	2024-11-12: YouTube tested AI restyling of licensed songs for Shorts using Dream Track technology.	Medium	Verify source before final board snapshot.
Microsoft TakeLessons	Market move	2024-11-15: Microsoft's TakeLessons marketplace closed, with account access ending in November 2024.	High	Verify source before final board snapshot.
Music.AI / Moises	Market move	2025-01-22: Music.AI raised a \$40M Series A and reported Moises at 50M users.	High	Verify source before final board snapshot.

Appendix-only market moves

Appendix

Date	Move Type	Player Or Signal	What Happened	Curation Note	Confidence	News Grade
2024-06-20	Product / guitar learning	Rocksmith+	Rocksmith+ continued cross-platform subscription positioning for learning real songs with real instruments.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	Medium	C
2024-07-15	Practice utility	Chord ai	Chord ai public listings positioned AI chord, beat and song-structure recognition as a play-any-song utility.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	Medium	C
2025-02-01	Creator community	BandLab	BandLab continued to present itself as a 100M+ creator and fan platform.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	High	C
2025-06-01	Teacher network	Lessonface	Lessonface continued positioning as a marketplace for vetted online music teachers and live lessons.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	Medium	C
2025-07-01	Practice ecosystem	MuseScore	MuseScore public app listings emphasized interactive sheet music, tabs and large score access.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	Medium	C
2025-09-01	Creator education	Pianote / Musora	Musora education brands continued to scale YouTube-led funnels for piano, drums, guitar and voice.	Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item.	Medium	C